Beyond Data pitch: voiceover script

752 WORDS · ABOUT 5 MIN AT 150 WPM · 22 OCT 2026

1 Opening 0:00–1:00

Globe A data centre serves the world. Search, streaming, banking, AI: they all run through buildings like this one.

Dive to the block But it lives here. On a real block, in a real neighbourhood.

Power, water, heat, noise It draws power and water from the city. What it gives off, heat and noise, goes to waste. A building type that only takes from its immediate setting.

First line draws So what if it gave something back?

Five more lines Or many things. Heat, power, water, space, materials, even sound.

Both ways An exchange, both ways.

Ethos Data centres are being built. So let's build them as neighbours, and find where they can give the most back.

Title This is Beyond Data.

2 What it is 1:00–1:08

Vancouver, Edmonton Beyond Data is a tool that tests any real lot. In Vancouver, and in Edmonton.

3 Heat and cold 1:08–1:25

Take heat. Servers make heat, and today most of it is thrown away. A heat pump can lift it high enough to warm a school, a heat network, a pool, homes, or a greenhouse. Each one is tested, condition by condition.

4 Energy 1:25–1:38

Energy. The grid connection is held, not used up, and the site can use less when asked. That could charge cars, help the utility, hold reserves for the grid operator, or help steady the grid.

5 Water 1:38–1:51

Water. The cooling choice decides the water. Blowdown can be reused, rain collected, the rest sent to treatment. Or the site can cool with reclaimed water.

6 Materials 1:51–2:03

Materials. The building stays; the servers leave in batches every five or six years. They can be refurbished, passed on, or sorted for their metals. A rack at refresh is a small urban mine: copper, steel, and the rare earths in its drives.

7 People and place 2:03–2:16

And people. The building asks things of its street, like quiet at night. It could give back jobs, a refuge in an outage, a ground floor for the city, a better frontage.

8 Sources and levels 2:16–2:44

Pages pile up This simulation is rooted in science, building codes, utility rates and documented case studies. Seven hundred and four sources, and growing.

Kinds Each source is marked by type, so you can see what a figure rests on: a study, a regulation, or an operator's claim.

Levels But a neighbour, a city planner and an engineer need different things. So the tool has three levels. Everyday is what a neighbour feels: noise, light, their power bill. Civic is what a city decides: who pays, grid headroom, a rezoning. Technical shows every formula and every source.

9 Logic diagram 2:44–3:38

Overview This is the logic the tool runs on. Eight stages, a hundred and ninety-five parts. From what we start with, to who gains and who pays.

The heat chain For example, follow the heat. From the parcel, to how big the building can be, to the IT load. Then the heat it rejects, the heat a pump can deliver, and the homes it could warm. Sources feed each step, all the way to who gains, and who pays.

Check the math You can check the math. Every figure shows its working, and where its numbers come from.

Trust key And how far to trust it. Every figure is rated out of a hundred: plain arithmetic rates highest, government data and regulations next, and an operator's claim lowest.

Weakest link A figure is only as sure as its weakest link. Homes heated uses government data, so on its own it rates eighty. But it rests on how much power the servers draw, which is an operator's claim or an estimate. So the chain rates fifty.

10 What it automates 3:38–3:54

The team This is work usually split across a team. Planners, analysts, architects, engineers, economists, lawyers.

Hand-off The tool does a first pass, on any real lot. It's an early feasibility study: it doesn't replace the engineer, it shows them where to look first.

Who asks what And it answers each person's question. Will I hear it? Is it allowed, and who pays? How is that worked out? Same lot, same facts, three ways in.

11 Tool demo 3:54–4:22

Here's 1425 Clark Drive, in Vancouver. The tool fits a data centre to the lot. Then it finds who nearby could take its heat, and the best set-up it can find. Then the opportunities, and the options, side by side.

12 The report 4:22–4:42

Covers Each level gets its own report.

Scatter And it's honest about what it finds. Around Clark Drive, none of the 688 buildings pays back yet.

The gap But it shows what would close the gap. Higher gas prices. A cheaper pipe route. A pipe already in the street.

Two cities In Edmonton, the same heat is worth about a third as much. Same logic, different answer.

Close Trade-offs, not verdicts.

13 Future and logo 4:42–end

Future scene So what will the urban data centre of the future offer, beyond data? Solar on the roof. Cars charging out front. Water and heat traded with the city.

Logo *no voice; the logo holds*